

ENG523 SHORT HANDOUTS

MIDTERM

Lesson 06 to 10

(ENG523) Discourse Analysis

EFFORT BY VUHELPERS24 TEAM

REGARDS : SIR ZAHID: 03342743020

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Lecture-06

Pragmatics and the Acquisition of Discourse

Pragmatics and the Acquisition of Discourse

What is pragmatics, and what does it study in relation to communication?

Pragmatics is the study of meaning in relation to the context in which a person is speaking or writing, which includes social, situational, textual, and background knowledge context.

What is cross-cultural pragmatics, and why is it significant in the study of pragmatics?

Cross-cultural pragmatics refers to the study of how the use of language varies across different cultures in terms of communication norms and expectations.

Define speech act theory and explain its components.

Speech act theory is the idea that words can perform actions in addition to conveying literal meanings. It consists of locutionary acts, illocutionary acts, and perlocutionary acts.

Provide an example of a speech act and explain how it works in context.

An example is saying "I do" in a marriage ceremony, where the words have both a literal meaning and perform the action of becoming legally married.

How do felicity conditions relate to speech acts?

Felicity conditions are the conditions or rules that determine whether a specific speech act is successful or not.

What is the connection between pragmatics and discourse analysis?

Both pragmatics and discourse analysis investigate context, text, function, and the significance of words in communication.

How do pragmatics and discourse analysis differ in their focus?

Discourse analysis examines how stretches above the sentence level are connected, while pragmatics delves into the identification of the speaker's intention and covert elements in communication.

What aspects of context are crucial for the production and interpretation of discourse?

Situational context, background knowledge context, and co-textual context are crucial for understanding spoken and written discourse.

How does background knowledge context influence the interpretation of discourse?

It includes cultural and interpersonal knowledge, norms, and expectations, shaping the way people interpret communication in a given discourse community.

Explain the concept of cross-cultural pragmatics with an example.

Cross-cultural pragmatics deals with variations in how speech acts are performed and interpreted across cultures. For instance, different implications may be drawn from an apology in English compared to Japanese.

Provide an example of how language use differs in thanking between Japanese and English.

In English, thanking expresses positive feelings in return for a favor, while in Japanese culture, it may involve apologizing and expressing indebtedness.

How does the Korean language exhibit variations in thanking and apologizing?

In Korean, the term "mainhada" can mean both "sorry" and "thanks," and it is used differently based on the speaker's ability to return the favor or request a favor.

Language Functions

What is a language function?

A language function refers to what students do with language as they engage with content and interact with others.

What are some common oral language functions?

Giving instructions, making requests, defending an argument.

What functions are commonly used in academic writing?

Describing processes, comparing or contrasting things or ideas, classifying objects or ideas.

Language Forms

What do language forms deal with?

Language forms deal with the internal grammatical structure of words and phrases, as well as cross-curricular academic vocabulary.

Give examples of cross-curricular academic vocabulary.

Verbs (e.g., hypothesize, analyze), complex prepositions (e.g., in contrast to, as well as), nouns (e.g., comparison, conclusion, analysis).

The Relationship Between Functions and Forms

What is the relationship between functions and forms in language learning?

Functions address what we do with language, while forms are the language structures and vocabulary used to support those functions. Both are essential for language proficiency.

Why is it important for teachers to understand the language demands of a task?

Teachers need to understand the language demands of a task as they relate to both function and form to best support students' language development.

Productive Discourse

What does a "productive" discourse involve?

A productive discourse involves participants paying close attention to and understanding each other's perspectives, responding with evidence, and being respectful of each other's ideas.

Does a productive discourse require participants to come to an agreement?

No, a productive discourse doesn't necessarily require participants to come to an agreement; it's more about respectful and evidence-based communication.

Second Language Acquisition

What is discourse knowledge in second language acquisition?

Discourse knowledge relates to the set of norms, preferences, and expectations for using language in context, including verbal acts, conversational sequences, and communicative styles.

How can language vary with psychological context?

Language can vary with psychological context by conveying emotions through linguistic resources such as intonation, voice quality, and word choices.

Child Discourse

What is the focus of child discourse studies?

Child discourse studies focus on understanding how children learn to use language in context and how they acquire communicative competence in everyday situations.

How has the field of child discourse studies evolved over the years?

The field has shifted from a focus on linguistic competence to communicative competence, including sociolinguistic practices, affect, and contextually situated learning.

What are some areas of study in child discourse?

Areas of study include adult-child discourse, child-child discourse, pragmatics of family life, personhood, self-identity, morality, disputes, teasing, gossip, and pretend play among children.

Adult-Child Discourse

What is the role of family discourse in children's learning experiences?

Answer: Family discourse helps children learn about verbal communication, power, and interpersonal relationships.

How do children develop communication skills within the family context?

Answer: Children develop their communication skills by participating in family life and observing how talk is used for various purposes.

In what situations do children hone their communication skills within the family?

Answer: Mealtimes and ceremonial occasions are key situations where children practice and refine their communication skills.

What do children learn through family discussions about narratives?

Answer: Children learn to construct narratives that reflect past and future events through family discussions.

How do children become aware of relationships beyond the family?

Answer: Family discussions also introduce children to relationships in the wider world.

According to Ervin-Tripp, what aspects of family talk impact interpersonal relationships?

Answer: Ervin-Tripp's analysis focuses on speech acts, such as requests, directives, greetings, and jokes, that demonstrate control over others.

What distinction does Ervin-Tripp make between effective power and esteem in the family context?

Answer: Effective power is the ability to get compliance, while esteem is the right to receive verbal deference.

Is there a direct correspondence between descriptors of status and verbal behavior in everyday life?

Answer: No, there is not a direct correspondence, as various factors influence verbal behavior and pragmatic choices.

Child-Child Discourse

What marked a new movement in child language research in addition to Child Discourse?

Answer: Developmental pragmatics and the study of situationally embedded activities organized by children themselves marked a new movement.

How do children demonstrate ingenuity in their play and games?

Answer: Children make use of repetition, sound play, and "attuned poetic performance" in their play and games.

Besides language skill, what did research in child language studies begin to focus on?

Answer: Research started to focus on relating children's knowledge and performance to social and cultural structures and ideologies within their own peer or sibling-kin group communities.

What kinds of social practices and genres do children use to negotiate belonging and hierarchy within peer groups?

Answer: Children use various practices such as arguments, songs, rhymes, pretend play, gossip stories, teasing, and jokes to negotiate belonging, norms, and social hierarchy within peer groups.

What are some examples of genres that older children use to negotiate alignments and hierarchy within the peer group?

Answer: Disputes, teasing, and gossip events are examples of genres used by older children to negotiate alignments and hierarchy within peer groups.

Where can readers find recent reviews of studies on children's discourse, disputes, and play?

Answer: Recent reviews of these studies can be found in literature reviews by Goodwin and Kyratzis in 2012 and 2014.

Lecture-07

Discourse: Gender, Racism and Religion

Discourse and Gender

What disciplines are involved in the study of discourse and gender?

Answer: The study of discourse and gender involves scholars in linguistics, anthropology, communications, social psychology, education, literature, and other interdisciplinary fields.

What are the two main focuses of the study of gender and discourse?

Answer: The study focuses on linguistic resources individuals use to present themselves as gendered beings and the discursive construction of gender through words and images.

Name two influential edited volumes that maintained an early focus on gender and discourse.

Answer: "Women and Language in Literature and Society" (1980) and "Language, Gender and Society" (1983).

What does the concept of "face" in Goffman's theory refer to?

Answer: "Face" refers to an individual's public image of themselves, consisting of approved social attributes that need to be maintained and protected.

Why does Brown (1980) claim that women are more polite in language use?

Answer: Brown suggests that women are more polite because they are culturally demoted to an inferior status relative to men.

Language and Gender Online

Who is considered an innovator in Computer-Mediated Communication (CMC) research?

Answer: Susan Herring is considered an innovator in CMC research.

Did the prediction that CMC would be gender-neutral hold true?

Answer: No, the prediction that CMC would be gender-neutral did not hold true. Gender-related patterns persisted in online discourse.

How do gender differences in participation vary by online context?

Answer: Women tend to outnumber and be more active than men on social networking sites like Facebook and Twitter, while men participate more on music-sharing sites, professional social networking sites like LinkedIn, and social news websites.

What types of social media attention do men and women receive differently?

Answer: Men's online discourse often receives more retweets and links in mass media, while women may receive more online harassment and threatening language when they speak up on social media sites.

Discourse and Racism

How was "race" traditionally defined in terms of genetics?

Answer: Traditionally, "race" was defined as populations differing in the incidence of certain genes but potentially able to exchange genes across geographic boundaries.

Why is the use of the term 'race' challenged by some?

Answer: Some challenge the use of 'race' because it intensifies problems of racism and because it doesn't consider increased racial mixing and the social construction of 'race.'

What does racism include, and how does discourse play a crucial role in it?

Answer: Racism includes marking and stereotyping differences, naturalization of cultural differences, hierarchization, and negative evaluation. Discourse plays a crucial role in these processes.

What is the relationship between categorization, stereotyping, and prejudice in social cognition models of prejudice?

Answer: Social cognition models suggest that categorization leads to stereotyping, which can occur automatically and lead to prejudice based on group membership.

What are some criticisms of social cognition models of prejudice?

Answer: Critics argue that these models normalize prejudice, treat racial categories as natural rather than social constructs, and may reproduce subtle racism.

What are the key cognitive strategies involved in prejudiced social information processing?

The strategies include participant categorization, use of prototypical properties, confirmation of negative group schemata, negative information retrieval, and others.

Religious Language

What does the term "religious language" refer to?

Religious language refers to statements or claims made about God or gods.

What is the problem of religious language?

The problem of religious language involves the ambiguity in meaning when using words to describe an infinite God with terms predicated of finite creatures.

How do metaphors affect religious texts?

Metaphors in religious texts introduce additional layers of meaning and can lead to different interpretations.

Give some examples of features of religious language identified by John Du Bois.

Use of rituals, archaic elements, euphemism and metaphor, semantic opacity, unusual fluency, and magic words.

Religion as a Cultural System

According to Geertz, how does culture relate to religion?

Culture is defined as a historically transmitted pattern of meanings embodied in symbols, used by humans to communicate, perpetuate, and develop their attitudes toward life.

What are the four things that religion does, according to Geertz?

Religion establishes powerful moods and motivations, formulates a general order of existence, makes these conceptions appear as fact, and makes these moods and motivations seem uniquely realistic.

Discourse and Religion

What is the fundamental problem addressed by discourse and religion in communication with immaterial agents?

The fundamental problem is how to communicate with immaterial agents, such as gods, spirits, and ancestors, who cannot speak back.

How do linguistic and discursive resources address the "problem of presence" in communication with immaterial interlocutors?

Highly marked and self-conscious uses of linguistic resources, dramatic departures from ordinary speech, are employed to address this problem.

How does participant role resolution contribute to communication with immaterial agents?

Resolving the participant role of "speaker" into multiple roles allows individuals to play many parts in communication with immaterial agents, and reported speech is indispensable in this process.

What is the significance of "recipient design" in human interaction, especially in the context of discourse and religion?

"Recipient design" refers to the orientation and sensitivity to the particular others in a conversation. In the context of discourse and religion, it becomes important to consider how one can communicate when the co-participants aren't sensorially present.

Lecture-08

Political Discourse and the Role of Multimedia in Discourse Analysis

Political Discourse

What is one of the central concerns of political discourse?

The central concern of political discourse is how the world is presented to the public through linguistic representation.

How do linguistic representations attribute meaning to individuals and groups?

Linguistic representations attribute meaning to individuals and groups by describing their social practices and actions.

What is the claim regarding "reality" and language?

The claim is that "reality" is not simply given to us through language; it is mediated through different forms of language representation.

According to some cognitive scientists, what is the nature of mental representation?

Some cognitive scientists argue that mental representation is at least in part metaphoric, where metaphor is not solely a linguistic phenomenon but a mode of thought.

Why is metaphor used in mental representation?

Metaphor is used in mental representation to make abstract and complex ideas more understandable by relating them to concrete concepts.

Who championed Cognitive Linguistics as a theory?

Cognitive Linguistics is championed by scholars like Lakoff and Johnson.

What is the main focus of this article regarding metaphoric representation?

The article focuses on metaphoric representation as a theory of conceptual structure, rather than addressing other views of its proponents.

What are the explicit parts of verbal metaphor?

In verbal metaphor, there are two explicit parts: the topic (entity being talked about) and the vehicle (metaphoric material predicated of the topic).

What does "ground" refer to in verbal metaphor?

The ground in verbal metaphor is the implicit connection between the topic and the vehicle, providing the basis for interpretation.

What is Critical Linguistics and its relationship to language?

Critical Linguistics views language as a reflection of social and cognitive aspects, displaying politics and ideology through grammatical structure.

How has Critical Linguistics evolved into Critical Discourse Analysis (CDA)?

Critical Linguistics has evolved into Critical Discourse Analysis (CDA) as a broader analytic program that examines how power, ideology, and domination are constituted through linguistic structures.

What criticism has been directed at CDA?

CDA has been criticized for its internal politicization and the assumption that certain data sets produce power abuse. It has also been criticized for its sociopolitical focus.

How has the "critical" approach to political discourse evolved in the past 20 years?

The "critical" approach to political discourse has become one of the fastest-growing areas of applied linguistic research, with scholars like Fairclough, Wodak, and van Dijk leading the way.

What role do prosody and phonetics play in political discourse?

Prosody and phonetics are used by politicians to influence how they are perceived by voters, and these features can convey political messages and emotions.

How can sounds and rhythm affect a politician's attractiveness to voters?

The sounds, rhythm, and prosodic features of a politician's speech can either attract or deter voters based on their perception of the speaker's attributes.

What did Duez's research suggest about temporal organization in political speeches?

Duez's research suggested that temporal organization in political speeches, such as articulation rate, could reflect a politician's relative distance from "power."

How can supra-segmental features be used in political discourse?

Supra-segmental features, like pitch, emphasis, and focus, can be harnessed and used in combination with syntactic, lexical, and pragmatic features to achieve specific political effects.

What are some argumentative goals that politicians may convey through prosodic features?

Politicians may convey assertiveness, irony, emotion, and hyperbole through specific prosodic features in their speech.

Why is the study of sounds and sound patterns important in political discourse analysis?

The study of sounds and sound patterns is important because it complements the analysis of linguistic and pragmatic aspects, providing a holistic view of political discourse.

What is one limitation in discussing metaphoric representation?

One limitation is the need to discuss verbal metaphor, which is a complex and challenging aspect of language, and even defining metaphor itself is not easy.

Approaches to Media Discourse

What is media discourse?

Media discourse refers to interactions through broadcast platforms, oriented to non-present audiences, and is public and manufactured.

What are the three main approaches to studying media discourse?

The three main approaches are discourse analytic, sociolinguistic, and nonlinguistic.

How can the discourse analytic approach be characterized?

It incorporates frameworks of pragmatics, conversation analysis, and sociological content analysis.

What is the significance of narrative structure in media discourse?

Narrative structure helps researchers understand how news stories are constructed and organized.

What is the role of the audience in media discourse analysis?

The audience is a crucial element and can be seen as both active and acted upon in the discourse.

Advertising and Discourse Analysis

What is the primary purpose of advertising?

Advertising is a means of communication to inform or influence people about a product or service.

Why is advertising considered a form of discourse?

Advertising is seen as a form of discourse because it reflects communication patterns and plays a significant role in society.

What are some criticisms of advertising as a form of discourse?

Advertising is criticized for its perceived lack of essential characteristics and its commercial nature.

How has advertising influenced language and communication?

Advertising has changed the structure and use of language, emphasizing persuasive techniques and creating a universal rhetoric in contemporary discourse.

What role does multimodality play in advertising discourse analysis?

Multimodality is essential in analyzing advertising campaigns as it considers how various media and elements work together to convey the message.

Discourse Analysis of Telecom Ads

How do telecom ads use font sizes and colors to capture the audience's attention?

Telecom ads utilize different font sizes and colors to make certain information stand out, while burying less essential details in small fonts.

Why do telecom ads include important conditions in fine print?

Telecom ads often include important conditions in fine print to minimize their visibility, increasing the chance that audiences will overlook them.

Lecture-09

Approaches and Methodologies in Discourse-I

Discursive Psychology and Discourse Analysis

What is discursive psychology, and how does it approach psychological matters?

Answer: Discursive psychology is an approach that examines psychological matters within the context of discourse in everyday conversations and interactions. It starts with how people experience psychology in their daily lives.

Name and explain the three fundamental observations about the nature of discourse in discursive psychology.

Answer:

a. Discourse is oriented to action: It focuses on how actions are performed through language rather than mental objects like intentions or dislikes.

b. Discourse is situated sequentially, institutionally, and rhetorically: It acknowledges that actions are influenced by the conversational context, institutional settings, and rhetorical strategies.

c. Discourse is constructed and constructive: It recognizes that language is constructed from various resources and can be analyzed for its conditions of assembly.

How does discursive psychology differ from cognitive psychology in terms of its approach to discourse?

Answer: Discursive psychology focuses on studying how actions are performed through discourse, while cognitive psychology primarily concerns itself with linguistic structure and abstract semantics.

What are the key ways in which actions are situated in discursive psychology?

Answer: Actions are situated in terms of the conversational sequence, institutional context, and rhetorical strategies.

How is action situated in terms of the "here and now" in conversational sequence?

Answer: Actions in discourse are highly influenced by the immediate context of the conversation, and talk is occasioned by what is happening at that moment.

Explain the concept of action being situated institutionally in discursive psychology.

Answer: Discursive psychology acknowledges that institutional settings, like a doctor's office, do not inherently dictate the type of discourse but are influenced by the actions and practices of individuals within them.

What role does rhetoric play in discursive psychology, and how is it connected to Billig's work?

Answer: Rhetoric is essential in discursive psychology, as it emphasizes the way descriptions are structured to counter potential alternatives and manage attempts to undermine them. Billig's work on rhetorical psychology contributed to this aspect of discursive psychology.

What resources are used in constructing discourse in discursive psychology, and why are they significant?

Answer: Discourse is constructed from various resources such as words, categories, rhetorical commonplaces, and grammatical structures. These resources are essential for both action and may pose challenges that require management.

How do researchers typically collect data for discursive psychology studies, and what kind of materials do they use?

Answer: Researchers collect audio or video recordings from various settings, such as neighbor dispute mediation services, child protection helplines, and family mealtimes, for their studies.

Describe the typical methodological procedures used in discursive psychology research.

Answer: Discursive psychology research often involves the analysis of audio/video recordings and transcripts, with research questions often emerging from the setting or a broad orientation to the materials.

How does the analysis in discursive psychology work with interactional materials, and what is the role of participants' orientations?

Answer: Participants' orientations are a primary analytic resource in discursive psychology, as they display their understanding of what is happening in the interaction. Participants turn towards interaction by addressing preceding talk, setting up conditions for future actions, and demonstrating their understanding of prior actions.

In discursive psychology, how is the concept of intention approached, and what distinguishes this approach from other social sciences?

Answer: Discursive psychology approaches intentions through the practical use of attributions of intention, intentional language, and semantic and grammatical resources, rather than conceptual analysis. This distinguishes it from other social sciences.

What critique does discursive psychology offer regarding the conceptualization of attitudes, and how does it view evaluations within interactions?

Answer: Discursive psychology emphasizes that evaluations are embedded in practices within interactions, playing particular roles. It highlights that evaluations often constitute the 'attitudinal object' rather than reflecting a personal psychological position.

How does discursive psychology challenge the idea of a single underlying attitudinal dimension regarding evaluations?

Answer: Discursive psychology challenges the idea of a single underlying attitudinal dimension by considering how different evaluations are produced for various purposes, such as distinguishing between 'objective' and 'subjective' food evaluations.

Interactional Sociolinguistics (IS)

What is Interactional Sociolinguistics?

Interactional Sociolinguistics (IS) is a perspective on language use in face-to-face interaction that focuses on the implicit communication and background knowledge needed for understanding speech.

How do people handle incomplete talk in IS?

People rely on background knowledge and contextual cues to make inferences and understand the meaning of incomplete speech.

How do words become indexical in IS?

Words have indexical meaning when they point to specific contexts in which they are used, requiring listeners to complete their meaning based on the situation.

What can happen when there are misinterpretations in IS?

Misinterpretations can lead to social consequences, such as misunderstandings, negative perceptions, and damaged relationships.

How does IS relate to cultural differences in communication?

IS explores how different cultural inferencing habits or contextualization styles can lead to misunderstandings and conflicts in communication.

What kind of data is needed for IS analysis?

IS analysis requires rich, firsthand data obtained through ethnographic fieldwork, recordings of natural speech, and detailed transcripts.

Why is Interactional Sociolinguistics important?

IS reveals the role of subtle cultural differences in communication, challenges stereotypes, and highlights the social and identity aspects of language use.

Discourse Analysis and Linguistic Anthropology

What is discourse analysis in linguistic anthropology?

Discourse analysis is the study of how language structures and influences social interactions, including the patterns of spoken and written language.

How does discourse analysis relate to culture?

Discourse analysis examines how language reflects and shapes cultural practices, identities, and social order.

What is the importance of discourse structuring in anthropology?

Discourse structuring helps anthropologists understand how people construct culture, roles, and identities through communication.

What role does linguistic anthropology play in understanding the relationship between language and culture?

Linguistic anthropology explores how language influences and is influenced by culture, social structures, and cultural identity.

How do linguistic anthropologists view the interdependence of language and culture?

Linguistic anthropologists see language as interdependent with culture and social structures, with both shaping and being shaped by each other.

Cultural Anthropology

What is culture in the context of cultural anthropology?

Culture refers to learned behaviors and shared beliefs that define a particular social, ethnic, or age group.

How does cultural anthropology study culture?

Cultural anthropology studies culture by examining the patterns of behavior, beliefs, and knowledge that characterize specific groups of people.

What is the principle of holism in cultural anthropology?

Holism in cultural anthropology means that understanding a part of something requires considering it within the context of the whole culture.

What is the principle of relativism in cultural anthropology?

Relativism in cultural anthropology suggests that all cultures are of equal value and should be studied from a neutral perspective, without imposing personal beliefs.

Why is cultural anthropology important in understanding diverse societies?

Cultural anthropology helps us understand the diversity of human cultures, social identities, and worldviews, particularly in a globalizing world.

Linguistic Anthropology

What is linguistic anthropology?

Linguistic anthropology is an interdisciplinary study of how language influences social life, including how language impacts culture and social interactions.

How does linguistic anthropology differ from linguistics?

Linguistic anthropology goes beyond language alone, examining how language interrelates with culture and social structures.

What role does language play in defining cultural identity in linguistic anthropology?

Language can be a defining element of cultural identity, as seen in cases where a unique language gives a group its cultural identity.

How does linguistic anthropology study the effects of language spread?

Linguistic anthropologists study the rate of language spread and its impact on societies, including the influence of global languages like English.

What areas of study are covered by linguistic anthropology?

Linguistic anthropologists explore language in everyday encounters, language socialization, ritual and political events, scientific discourse, and more, considering its interdependence with culture.

Lecture-10

Approaches and Methodologies in Discourse-II

Topic 1: English for Academic Purposes (EAP)

What is EAP?

Answer: EAP stands for English for Academic Purposes, which aims to assist learners in their academic study and research in the English language.

How did EAP initially focus in the 1980s?

Answer: In the 1980s, EAP primarily focused on curriculum and instruction rather than theory and analysis, emphasizing materials and teaching for text-based skills and study efficiency.

How has the role of EAP evolved over time?

Answer: EAP has become more theoretically grounded and research-informed, addressing the influence of culture, multiple literacies, and the English language skills of non-native English-speaking academics.

What are the challenges posed by the changing conditions in the academy?

Answer: Challenges include a more diverse student population, a broader range of academic subjects, and a variety of communication modalities.

Why has EAP gained prominence in the academy?

Answer: EAP has gained prominence due to the need for English language skills among non-native English-speaking academics for research, workshops, presentations, and conferences.

What does current EAP aim to achieve?

Answer: Current EAP aims to provide deeper insights into language use in academic contexts at all levels and to develop pedagogical practices informed by an understanding of texts and academic contexts.

How has discourse analysis contributed to understanding academic communication?

Answer: Discourse analysis has made a significant contribution by studying language in action and exploring the language patterns in academic genres and texts.

What is genre analysis, and how does it relate to discourse analysis?

Answer: Genre analysis focuses on recurrent language use in specific genres, helping to understand wider rhetorical practices in different academic communities.

What does self-mention in academic writing refer to, and why is it a notable issue?

Answer: Self-mention in academic writing pertains to the use of "I" or "we." It is a contentious issue because it relates to the level of personal involvement in academic writing.

How does the use of self-mention vary in different academic disciplines?

Self-mention varies based on the writer's role in constructing interpretations, setting out methodological procedures, and establishing authority in different academic disciplines.

Corpus Approaches to Discourse Analysis

What is a corpus in the context of discourse analysis?

Answer: A corpus is a collection of spoken or written authentic texts, representative of specific language use, which can be analyzed electronically.

What tools are used to access and analyze corpora?

Answer: Tools like concordances are used to access and analyze corpus data to identify language patterns and linguistic features.

What are the two main types of corpora, and how do they differ?

Answer: The two main types are general corpora (representing language use broadly) and specialized corpora (focusing on specific types of texts or genres).

How can a specialized corpus be used in research?

Answer: Specialized corpora are used to study language use in specific genres or domains, such as academic writing or particular types of discourse.

What is the process involved in designing and constructing a corpus for research?

Answer: Designing a corpus involves selecting and collecting texts that are representative of the research question, and they may be created specifically for a particular study.

How can custom-made corpora be useful in research?

Answer: Custom-made corpora are valuable for researching specific genres or areas of discourse use, especially when existing corpora do not meet the research needs.

What is the significance of the size of a custom-made corpus?

Answer: The size of a custom-made corpus depends on the research's purpose, and smaller, specialized corpora can be valuable for specific research questions.

Why do researchers create their own corpora for analysis?

Answer: Researchers create their own corpora when they want to investigate language use in specific genres, texts, or contexts that are not covered by existing corpora.

How can corpus-based discourse analysis contribute to understanding language use?

Answer: Corpus-based discourse analysis helps researchers examine language patterns, frequencies, and co-occurrences, leading to a better understanding of language use in specific contexts.

What is the role of corpus studies in language analysis?

Answer: Corpus studies focus on the occurrence and re-occurrence of linguistic features and patterns, providing insights into language use in different contexts and domains.

Issues in Constructing a Corpus

What considerations are involved in deciding what to include in a corpus?

Answer: Considerations include language variety, genre, modality (spoken, written), monologic vs. dialogic texts, and more.

How does corpus size impact corpus construction?

Answer: Corpus size matters, but the focus should also be on data collection methods and research questions.

What are some sociolinguistic and demographic considerations in corpus construction?

Answer: Nationality, gender, age, occupation, education level, native language or dialect, and participant relationships are important factors.

What are the key elements of authenticity, representativeness, and validity in corpus construction?

Answer: Authenticity, representativeness, and validity are crucial aspects to ensure the quality of a corpus.

What distinguishes a static corpus from a dynamic corpus?

Answer: A static corpus represents a particular point in time, while a dynamic corpus shows change in language use over time.

Kinds of Texts in a Corpus

What factors influence the decision on what kinds of texts to include in a corpus?

Answer: The decision depends on the corpus's purpose and the availability of texts.

Why is the permanence of a corpus important, and what are the options for it?

Answer: Permanence is about whether a corpus will be regularly updated or remain a snapshot of language use at a specific time.

How does the size of texts in a corpus affect representativeness?

Answer: Text size should reflect the typical length of texts in the genre or category being represented.

Why is achieving both representativeness and balance essential in corpus construction?

Answer: Both are necessary for a high-quality corpus but require judgment and approximation.

How should the compilation of a corpus be approached to ensure its quality?

Answer: It should occur in a cyclical fashion, based on theoretical analysis, pilot studies, data collection, and revision.

Politics as Usual and Discourse Analysis

Why is it challenging to explore the 'backstage' of politics?

Answer: The backstage involves complex, nontransparent political routines that require ethnographic research for understanding.

What are the four prominent linguistic-discursive approaches in organizational research?

Answer: Ethnomethodology, conversation analysis (CA), sociolinguistic analysis, and (critical) discourse analysis (CDA).

How does the interdependence of front-stage and backstage become apparent in political studies?

Answer: Studies show that much is decided backstage and then enacted and negotiated on the front stage.

What is the role of pragmatic-linguistic expertise in political discourse analysis?

Answer: It's crucial for understanding how power is exercised through shared knowledge, presuppositions, and indirect devices.

Discourse-Historical Approach (DHA)

What does the Discourse-Historical Approach (DHA) focus on in discourse analysis?

Answer: DHA looks at latent power dynamics, inter-textuality, and the range of potential in agents.

What are the four layers of context considered in systematic qualitative analysis within DHA?

Answer: Intertextual and inter-discursive relationships, social/sociological variables, history and archaeology, and institutional frames.

How does inter-textuality and contextualization play a role in political discourse analysis?

Answer: Inter-textuality links texts to other texts, and contextualization involves the process of moving an element to a new context.

Politics as Usual and Knowledge Management

Why is politics often characterized by chaos and unpredictability?

Answer: Politics is filled with accident, coincidence, and unpredictability, alongside well-planned, strategic action.

What role does knowledge management play in the everyday life of politicians?

Answer: Knowledge management is crucial for dealing with chaos and maintaining 'order in the disorder.'

How can the democratic deficit in politics be challenged, according to the text?

Answer: Making information about daily political work more publicly accessible is suggested to address the democratic deficit.

Working on the Next Lessons

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